

Digital Mapping Project

Rubric

Purpose

The purpose of this project is to familiarize you with thinking about lived religion and crafting digital projects to effectively convey information.

The project will have two constructive components: choosing the information you want and choosing the most effective tool to represent that information.

Choosing Sites

Part of this project is to get you thinking about religion in place; in the case of our class, religion in New York City. Although my examples will be Manhattan and Queens focused, you are free to base your project on any of the 5 boroughs.

Select 6-10 places of religious significance. Think expansively when choosing your sites.

These places do not have to be currently standing places of significance. They may be historical ones, meaning that they are no longer standing, but there is a legacy/record of them - such as the Temple Emanu-El of the Lower East Side (the one that preceded the current one in Midtown).

These sites also do not have to be literal religious institutions. For example, you could do Morningside Park, where the first publicly woman-led Muslim prayer was held in the United States, or a Sikh *langar* in Harlem, from the time of Black Lives Matter protests.

You may think about place through neighborhoods. In such a situation, you can map out sites in Astoria, for example. That mapping can include sites from multiple religions, or multiple sites from one religion.

You may think about place through time. In this instance, you can map the changing religious sites over a span of time. For example, you can look at the Lower East Side over a century and at how religious sites move.

You can think about place through religion. Choose a religion and map it throughout the city. So you could do St. Peter's on Church St., St. Patrick's Cathedral, and Holy Trinity on 82nd St., if you wanted to focus on Catholicism.

There may be something to do with the Tibetan Shrine Room at the Brooklyn Museum. If you want to think that something through, please reach out to me. <https://www.brooklynmuseum.org/exhibitions/rubin-museum-tibetan-buddhist-shrine-room>

There may be other variations that I have not enumerated, and you should feel free to ask about them as options. The point is for this to be expansive, creative, and tailored to your interests.

However, you must be able to articulate why you've chosen the sites you have. Simply listing them is not sufficient. **Clearly answer this question: what is it about your selection that**

should get a viewer excited about your project? You must have a uniting narrative that connects the sites you have selected.

Choosing Tools

In our time with the Digital Humanities Center (DHC) and the Empirical Reasoning Center (ERC), we will be introduced to a variety of tools that help map sites in different ways to communicate different stories. Our workshops will allow you to figure out what tool may work best for you and your goals. There is no “right” selection.

Constraints

This project is meant to be flexible, but there are some constraints, to make sure projects are diverse.

- I. You may not have more than one site in Morningside Heights/the Greater Contiguous Columbia University Real Estate Empire.
 - A. You need to have a compelling reason to include the Cathedral of St. John the Divine. Please get prior approval.
- II. You do not need to visit every site that you’ve chosen. You are welcome to use online research and Creative Commons/Copyleft images.
 - A. If you include two original images, you will receive one point of additional credit on the project. You may provide up to four images for two additional points. You do not need interior shots.

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1. Proposal/Outline - 2 points - Due October 8
The proposal should be between 200-300 words that describes what your narrative is, why your site selections support that narrative, and what you think a viewer may understand better about religion through your story.
2. Map - 5 points - Due October 22
Your map should present all your chosen sites, at a minimum, and any supplementary information as is appropriate for your chosen tool and the narrative you proposed. Both DHC/ERC will provide feedback on this section to the teaching staff.
3. Evaluation - 3 points - Due October 22
The evaluation should be a 250-300 word reflection on the process. You should include any thoughts you have about the appropriateness of your site selections in delivering your narrative and/or learning objectives; the selection of tools; any learnings about religion or your communities of interest.